

Iris SooJin Park

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Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison

Ph.D. Candidate, Insurance Economics and Actuarial Analytics	Expected May 2027
B.A., Economics with Mathematical Emphasis (Honors), GPA: 4.00/4.00	2021
B.A., Mathematics, GPA: 3.97/4.00	2021

Graduated with Distinction

Research Interests

Insurance economics; health economics; behavioral economics

Working Papers

- “Myopia, Price Perception, and Moral Hazard in Health Insurance” [\[PDF\]](#) *Job Market Paper*
- “The Generosity Paradox: When Less Generous Insurance Raises Spending” [\[PDF\]](#)
Under Review
- “The Impact of Decision Aids on Health Insurance Selection” *with Anya Samek and Justin Sydnor*
[\[PDF\]](#)
 - *Rising Financial Literacy Scholar Award*, 2026 Stanford Financial Education Symposium
- “To Smooth or Not to Smooth: Consumption Responses to Life Insurance Payouts” *with Tyler Welch* [\[PDF\]](#)

Works in Progress

- “How Information Display Affects Health Insurance Decisions” *with Justin Sydnor and Yuxin Wen*
- “Older Americans and Life Insurance” *with Tyler Welch* [\[Working Draft\]](#)
- “The Effects of Changes in Benefit Generosity: Evidence from Workers’ Compensation Coverage of Mental Health Conditions” *with Jonghwa Do and Tyler Welch*
- “Health Insurance, Long-Run Health, and Life-Cycle Spending” *with Laura Waring*

Publications

Park, S., & Deller, S. (2021). “Effect of farm structure on rural community well-being.” *Journal of Rural Studies*, 87, 300–313. (Undergraduate research)

Teaching Experience

University of Wisconsin–Madison

Undergraduate Courses

Teaching Assistant, Principles of Risk Management	Fall 2026
Teaching Assistant, Business Analytics II	Spring 2021–Spring 2024

M.S. in Business Analytics Courses

Teaching Assistant, Consulting Project Capstone	Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant, Experiments and Causal Methods for Business Insights	Fall 2025

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Prof. Justin Sydnor	2022–2025
Research Assistant, Prof. Steven Deller	2019–2021
Data Analyst Intern, Madison Region Economic Partnership	2020
Research Assistant, Korea Research Institute for Human Settlements (KRIHS)	2019

Presentations

American Risk and Insurance Association Annual Meeting, Orlando, FL	2026
Stanford Financial Education Symposium, Stanford, CA	2026
Behavioral Science and Health Symposium, Philadelphia, PA	2025
Stanford University, Health Econ Problem Solving Group, Stanford, CA	2025
UGA Ph.D. Student Research Symposium, Athens, GA	2025
American Risk and Insurance Association Annual Meeting, Denver, CO	2024
Southern Regional Science Association 60th Annual Meeting (Virtual)	2021
Undergraduate Symposium (Virtual)	2021

Policy Reports and Other Writing

“High-Deductible Health Plan Initiative Research Reports.” Prepared for the State of Wisconsin Group Insurance Board. [[Three-Part Report](#)]

- Report on Health Care Utilization Differences between IYC Health Plan and HDHP Enrollees.
- Report on Projecting Member Costs in the HDHP vs. IYC Health Plan.
- Report on Health Plan Choice Study

“Is Bigger Better? Farm Size and Community Well-Being.” *The Daily Yonder*, 2021

“Healthcare Industry Cluster.” Sector Abstracts, Madison Region Economic Partnership, 2019

Honors, Awards, and Grants

Awards

Rising Financial Literacy Scholar Award, Stanford Financial Education Symposium	2026
Three Minute Thesis Competition Finalist	2025
Trewartha Senior Honors Thesis Award	2021
Dean's Honors List, University of Wisconsin–Madison	2017–2021

Research Grants

Faculty & Graduate Student Research Grant, BRITE Lab	2025
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Travel Awards

Student Research Grant, University of Wisconsin–Madison	2024
Travel Award, Wisconsin School of Business	2024–2026

Scholarships and Fellowships

George Fait Insurance Scholarship	2025
Graduate Scholarship, Wisconsin School of Business	2021–2025
Hilldale Undergraduate/Faculty Research Fellowship	2020

Workshops

Financial Literacy Research Boot Camp	2025
Hosted by G53 Network and Stanford University's Initiative for Financial Decision-Making	

Reviewer Service

Journal of Risk and Insurance

Service

Committee Member, Ph.D. Student Committee on Inclusion	2024–Present
Outreach Assistant, <i>Journal of Risk and Insurance</i>	2021–2022

Memberships

Graduate Research Fellow, Institute for Research on Poverty	2025–Present
American Risk and Insurance Association	2024–Present
American Economic Association	2019–Present

References

Justin Sydnor Professor University of Wisconsin–Madison justin.sydnor@wisc.edu	Daniel Sacks Professor University of Wisconsin–Madison dan.sacks@wisc.edu	Anita Mukherjee Associate Professor University of Wisconsin–Madison anita.mukherjee@wisc.edu
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Citizenship: South Korea